

CHURCH LIFE AFRICA (CLA)
SUMMER CONFERENCE, 2022

Theme: Lay Theological Engagement and the Future of Church Life in Africa

Gaudium Et Spes Institute, Asokoro, Abuja
August 4-6, 2022

Program of Events

Day 1: Thursday, August 4, 2022

Time	Event	Anchor	Notes
Morning Session			
9:00-9:30	Opening Mass	Rev William Orbih Rev Kenneth Amadi Rev Joachim Ozonze	
9:40-10:00	Welcome and Introductions	Rev Ken Amadi	
10:00-10:15	Choral Performance	Rachel Okenwe, <i>Soloist</i> Arome Shaibu, <i>Organist</i>	<i>Bless this House</i> , by Helen Taylor and May H. Braher. <i>Ave Maria</i> by Pietro Mascagni
10:15-10:50	Our World is Evolving, so is the Church and its Theology	Rev Joachim Ozonze <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
10:50-11:05	Tea Break		
11:05-11:45	The Dynamics of an Explosive Christian Population in Africa: Do Numbers Guarantee Faith? (zoom)	Rev Emmanuel Ojeifo <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
11:45-12:45	Roundtable: The Future of Church Life in Nigeria: Trends and Projections	Dr Mrs. Omolara Akanji, <i>Consultant, CBCN</i> , Onize Ohikere, <i>World Magazine</i> , Rev Emmanuel Okonkwo, <i>Archdiocese of Abuja</i>	
12:45-1:30	Breakout Sessions	Groups 1-10	
1:30-2:30	Lunch Break		
Afternoon Session			
2:30-3:30	Keynote: The Centrality of Ritual to Church Life (zoom)	Prof Kimberly Belcher,	

		<i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
3:30-4:15	Art Exhibition: Imagining Church Life in Nigeria	Rozie Wylie	
4:15-5:00	Summation/Closing Ritual	Rev William Orbih <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	

Day 2: Friday, August 5, 2022

Time	Event	Anchor	Notes
Morning Session			
9:00-9:10	Sign-in and Welcome		
9:10-9:45	Sustaining the Catholic Identity in a Pluralistic Society: Liturgy as Identity Marker	Rev Kenneth Amadi, <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
9:45-10:45	Round Table The Possibility of a Catholic Culture in the Public Space	Amb Dr Martin Uhomoibhi, <i>PAIGAS, Abuja</i> Rev Robert Achiaga, <i>Archdiocese of Abuja</i> Chrisvic Ebodaghe, <i>Nile University</i>	
10:45-11:00	Tea Break		
11:00-11:30	Literature and the Christian Imagination	Rev William Orbih <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
11:30-11:45	Poetry Rendition	Willy Niccolo	
11:45-12:15	How Can Theology Contribute to Economic Development in Africa? (zoom)	Rev Prof Fidelis Olokunboro, <i>Cabrini University</i>	
12:15-12:45	Mass	John Cardinal Onaiyekan, <i>Archbishop Emeritus of Abuja</i>	
1:00-2:30	Lunch Break		
Afternoon Session			
2:30-3:30	Keynote: Is Theology Crucial for Church Life? Should We all be Theologians? (zoom)	Prof David Fagerberg <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
3:30-3:45	Art Exhibition (comics): Can We Too Study Theology?	Gabriel Eyemese	
3:30-4:30	Breakout Session	Groups 1-10	
4:30-5:00	Summation and Closing Ritual	Chinelo Chikelu, <i>Leadership Newspaper</i>	

Day 3: Saturday, August 6, 2022

Time	Event	Anchor	Notes
Morning Session			
9:00-9:30	Mass	Most Rev Anselm Umoren, <i>Auxiliary Bishop, Archdiocese of Abuja</i>	
9:30-9:40	Sign-in and Welcome		
9:40-10:00	Goodwill Message	Most Rev Anselm Umoren	
10:00-11:00	Round Table: Catholic Education and Catechesis in Nigeria: Successes, Challenges, and Prospects	Rev James Akpaamo, <i>Abuja Archdiocese</i> , Oby Chris-Chukwu, <i>St Aloysius School, Garki</i> , Eucharica Ejike, <i>Regina Pacis College, Garki</i> Francis Ogbu, <i>Holy Trinity Parish, Maitama</i>	
11:00-12:30	Film Screening (with snack break)	Babbette's Feast	
12:30-12:45	Break		
12:45-1:15	Catholic Bioethics and Knowledge Gap in the Catholic Moral Tradition	Rev Joseph Obada, <i>Archdiocese of Abuja</i>	
1:15-1:45	Art Exhibition: The State of Catechesis in Nigeria	Venny Artz	
1:45-2:30	Breakout Sessions	Groups 1-10	
2:30-3:30	Keynote: Lay Theologians: Africa's Theological Deficit – Challenges and Prospects	Rev Prof Paulinus Odozor, C.S.Sp., <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
3:30-4:00	Summation and Wrap-up	Rev Joachim Ozonze, <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	
4:00-5:00	Closing Ceremonies/Dinner	Racheal Okenwe, <i>Soloist</i> , Arome Shaibu, <i>Organists</i> , Chika Kamalu, <i>Violinist</i>	<i>Tobenu Chukwu</i> , by Vincent Ihara <i>Ave Maria</i> , by Williams Gomez